Minutes of the Special Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically on Monday, December 15, 2025

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:

accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Mayor	-	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	-	M. Crawford
		-	S. Lee
		-	J. Dies
	Councillors	-	R. Tyler Morin
		-	N. Henry
		-	L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Chair – Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 9:04 a.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

Mayor Collier declared a pecuniary interest with respect to part-time aquatics wages and benefits (Item 4.4.1), as he has a family member employed by the Town who works in aquatics.

3. Mayor's Opening Comments

Mayor Collier, Budget Chair, provided opening comments, thanked staff for their hard work on the preparation of the 2026 Capital Budget and 2027 – 2035 Long Range Capital Forecast and 2026 Operating Budget, and reviewed highlights of the Mayor's proposed 2026 budget.

4. Capital Budget and Operating Budget

4.1 Capital and Operating Budget Presentations

Julie Mepham, Acting Director of Finance/Treasurer delivered a presentation on the 2026 Capital Budget and 2027 – 2035 Long Range Capital Forecast and the 2026 Operating Budget.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. J. Mepham responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: S. Lee

That the Capital Budget Presentation and Operating Budget Presentation be received for information.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4.2 **Public Comments & Questions**

Chair Collier invited comments and questions from the public on the proposed 2026 Capital Budget and 2027 – 2035 Long Range Capital Forecast and 2026 Operating Budget.

The following Ajax residents provided comments to Council regarding the proposed 2026 Capital Budget and 2027 – 2035 Long Range Capital Forecast and 2026 Operating Budget:

- **Douglas Glass**
- **Cathy Hollis**
- **Imtiaz Mohammed**

Council Members asked questions related to the delegations.

Christie McLardie, Director of Public & Strategic Affairs, J. Mepham, and Mayor Collier, responded to questions and comments from the delegates.

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked each delegate.

4.3 **Discussion and Opportunity for Amendments**

Council Members asked questions related to the proposed amendments. J. Mepham, Mayor Collier, Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, and Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Council Members.

Operating Budget Amendments

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

1. **That the 2% Infrastructure Levy be reduced to 1%.**

   Sponsored by Regional Councillor Lee

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: Mayor Collier

CARRIED

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: M. Crawford

2. **That $5,000 be added to the Operations & Environmental Services Budget for a 3-Way Stop at the intersection of Williamson Dr. W. and Seggar Ave.**

   Sponsored by Councillor Henry

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Henry

Opposed: Mayor Collier, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

FAILED

Capital Budget Amendments

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: S. Lee

3. **That the Pickering Village Redevelopment (project 24004701) be reduced from $3M to $500K in 2026, with the $2.5M being returned to the Housing Accelerator Fund (HAF).**

   Sponsored by Mayor Collier

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: M. Crawford

4. **That the Pedestrian Crosswalk (PXO) at Williamson Dr. W. and Seggar Ave. (project 26002701) be added to the Planning & Development Services Capital Budget in the amount of $225,000 funded from the Development Reserve.**

   Sponsored by Councillor Henry

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: M. Crawford

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Henry

Opposed: Mayor Collier, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

FAILED

Council Members asked questions related to the 2026 Capital and Operating Budget. D. Meredith, Mayor Collier, J. Mepham, Chris Walker, Chief Information Officer, Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer, and G. Romanowski, responded to questions from Council Members.

Council Members sought clarification regarding the veto period. Jaclyn Grossi, Municipal Clerk, responded to questions from Council Members.

Mayor Collier vacated the Chair. Regional Councillor Lee assumed the Chair.

4.4 Council Approval of Items Subject to Mayor Pecuniary Interest

4.4.1. Part-time Aquatics Wages and Benefits

Council Members requested clarification as to why Item 4.4.1, Part-time Aquatics Wages and Benefits, was separated for voting. J. Grossi responded to questions from Council Members.

Mayor Collier abstained from voting due to his declared pecuniary interest.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That Council approve the budget allocation for part-time aquatics wages in accordance with Section 8(a) of O. Reg 530/22.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

Mayor Collier resumed the Chair.

5. Confirming By-law

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

That By-law number 98-2025 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its special meeting held on December 15, 2025, be approved.

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

6. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the December 15, 2025 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned. (11:03 a.m.)

In Favour: Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

_____
Mayor and CEO

_____
Clerk